The world in brief

Catch up quickly on the global stories that matter

Ariel Henry, **Haiti's** embattled prime minister, tendered his resignation following talks with regional leaders in Jamaica. Mr Henry has been unable to return to Haiti following a trip to Kenya, after gangs took control of Port-au-Prince, the capital. They demanded that he step down. The unelected Mr Henry has run the Caribbean island since the assassination of Jovenel Moïse, the president, in 2021.

President Joe Biden proposed a $7.3trn budget for the coming fiscal year. The plan proposes lower costs of child care and housing, among other things, funded by higher taxes on corporations and the rich. But Mr Biden's proposal will probably not pass the House of Representatives, which is controlled by Republicans.

China criticised **India** for opening a tunnel near the border between the two countries. Last week Narendra Modi, India's prime minister, inaugurated the construction in a part of the north-eastern state of Arunachal Pradesh claimed by China. India said the tunnel would be used by its army. China said India "has no right" to build infrastructure in the "southern region of Tibet".

Israel launched several air strikes against targets in **Lebanon**. The Israel Defence Forces said the action was retaliation for attacks by Hizbullah, an Iran-backed militant group. The IDF also continued its assault in Gaza as the holy month of Ramadan began. Meanwhile the departure of the first ship carrying humanitarian aid from Cyprus to Gaza was delayed.

John Barnett, a former **Boeing** employee and whistleblower, was found dead in a hotel car park in Charleston, South Carolina. Police

are investigating the death, but the coroner said Mr Barnett died because of a “self-inflicted” wound. During Mr Barnett’s 32-year tenure at Boeing, he often raised concerns about the planemaker’s production standards. After retirement, he sued the company for hampering his career.

France suffered a series of **cyber-attacks** of “unprecedented” intensity, according to the prime minister’s office. The source of the attacks, which hit several government departments and “many ministerial services”, is unconfirmed. A few hacker groups claimed responsibility on Telegram, a messaging service, including a pro-Russian group called Anonymous Sudan.

Airbnb said it would ban the use of indoor security cameras in its listed properties. The short-term rental firm had previously allowed cameras in “common areas” such as corridors and sitting rooms, as long as their presence was disclosed. Guests have often complained about their privacy being intruded upon. Landlords that install them claim they are intended to check for illicit parties and the like.

Fact of the day: Two**,** the number of third-party candidates that have taken more than 5% of the national vote in America’s presidential election in the past 50 years. Read the full story.

In the run-up to America’s presidential election, we’ve launched The US in brief—a daily update to help you keep on top of the political stories that matter. Sign up here to receive it as a newsletter, each weekday, in your inbox

Photo: AP

Biden’s budget day

America’s Congress is still haggling over this year’s budget. But negotiations are about to begin on next year’s. On Monday Joe Biden released his plan for the coming fiscal year. The president’s blueprint—a $7.3trn proposal meant, in part, to make childcare and housing cheaper—has no chance of becoming law because Republicans control the House of Representatives. But the budget is an opportunity for him to say what his priorities are ahead of the presidential election.

He is likely to propose a refreshed version of Bidenomics. The plan may feature increased spending on health insurance for the elderly, on tax credits for young families and on preschools. To pay for all this, Mr Biden will call for higher taxes on corporations and the rich. Republicans will call it a reckless tax-and-spend budget; Mr Biden will deem it essential to the country’s future. Fiscal policy may not be top of mind for most voters. But those who care will have two starkly different visions to choose between in November.

Chaos reigns in Haiti

On Monday Caribbean leaders are expected to meet in Jamaica to discuss the crisis in Haiti. They have invited officials from other countries, including America, Canada and France; America said on Monday that Antony Blinken, the secretary of state, would attend. Gangs control 80% of Port-au-Prince, Haiti's capital. In early March they took over critical buildings such as police stations and government offices, and attacked the airport. The most prominent gang leader said the aim was to topple Ariel Henry, the prime minister. He has ruled unelected since the assassination of Haiti's president in 2021 and is very unpopular.

The Caribbean leaders may add to the pressure on Mr Henry to resign. He is in Puerto Rico, unable to return safely to Haiti. His resignation could make way for a transition government and then, eventually, elections. But any peaceful solution relies on the arrival of a planned security mission. Kenya has agreed to lead the UN-authorised deployment but does not yet have enough money or soldiers as countries hesitate over committing troops. With or without Mr Henry, Haiti's path ahead is treacherous.

Photo: Reuters

Japan’s two-track economy

Japan’s economy grew by 0.4% in the last quarter of 2023, according to revised figures released on Monday. The initial estimates showed a 0.4% contraction, the second straight quarter of decline. That meant that Japan’s economy was technically in recession. Thanks to strong capital expenditure, the fresh numbers proved rosy enough to affirm that Japan was not. Nonetheless, consumption remained sluggish, casting doubt on the economy’s strength.

The real economy’s struggles stand in stark contrast with Japan’s stockmarkets, which are booming. Bumper corporate profits, a weak yen and rising shareholder returns have lured international investors back to Japan. The benchmark Nikkei stock index is up around 20% since the start of the year, breaking an all-time high set in 1989. For the economy to prosper as the stockmarket is doing, companies will need to raise wages enough to encourage growth in domestic demand.

Photo: Alamy

Who can buy a leading conservative British newspaper?

Should an entity backed by a foreign government have a controlling stake in one of Britain's most influential conservative newspapers? That question may soon be answered by Ofcom, Britain's media regulator. Monday is the deadline for the watchdog to provide a report to Lucy Frazer, the culture secretary, on the proposed purchase by RedBird IMI of Telegraph Media Group, the owner of the *Daily* and *Sunday Telegraph*.

The prospective buyer is a joint venture between RedBird Capital Partners, an American firm, and International Media Investments. That is the investment vehicle of Sheikh Mansour bin Zayed al-Nahyan, the vice-president of the United Arab Emirates. He is known to many Britons as the owner of Manchester City, a successful English football club. Ofcom's report will cover whether the deal poses a threat to free expression and to news impartiality. The *Telegraph* has run many articles critical of the sale, which is also opposed by a large number of Conservative MPs.

Photo: T. Charles Erickson

A media scandal on stage

“Succession” was a television show that dramatised a power struggle within a media empire. Its creator admitted that Rupert Murdoch’s real-life dynasty was an inspiration. Fans of the show, which ended last year, will probably enjoy “Corruption”, a play by J.T. Rogers. It is now playing at Lincoln Centre in New York.

The play focuses on a scandal at the *News of the World*, a now-closed British tabloid owned by Mr Murdoch. In 2011 it was revealed that journalists at the paper had hacked the phones of many prominent Britons. One victim was Tom Watson, then a Labour MP. “Corruption” dramatises Mr Watson’s efforts to take on Rebekah Brooks, a former editor at the *News of the World* who had become an executive in Mr Murdoch’s business. (Ms Brooks left her job owing to the scandal in 2011, but was acquitted of criminal charges and returned to work for Mr Murdoch in 2015.) A halo of screens hangs above the stage. That makes “Corruption” feel less like theatre and more like a Netflix series.

Daily quiz

We will serve you a new question each day this week. On Friday your challenge is to give us all five answers and, as important, tell us the connecting theme. Email your responses (and include mention of your home city and country) by 1700 GMT on Friday to . We'll pick randomly from those with the right answers and crown three winners on Saturday.

Monday: The Institutional Revolutionary Party ruled which country continuously from 1929 to 2000?

He who rejects change is the architect of decay.

Harold Wilson